

LING 336/536: Sound Systems in Use Fall 2018 (last edited 11/2/18)

COURSE TIME	Mondays & Wednesdays, 3:30-5:00 pm
LOCATION	3401-C Walnut, Room 326
INSTRUCTOR	Dr. Meredith Tamminga
CONTACT	tamminga@ling.upenn.edu
OFFICE	3401-C Walnut, Room 316
OFFICE HOURS	Wednesdays 1-2 pm, or by appointment
TA	John McGahay
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OFFICE HOURS	TBA

OVERVIEW

Much linguistic research takes controlled experiments, elicited utterances, or metalinguistic judgments as primary empirical data. In this course we tackle a different kind of data: the rich but messy data of conversational speech. What can we learn about phonetics and phonology from the way people use language in everyday life?

This hands-on course has both methodological and theoretical goals. On the methodological side, students will learn to extract and analyze linguistic data from time-aligned corpora of spontaneous speech. On the theoretical side, students will learn to relate quantitative corpus data to questions about the structure and diachrony of phonetic and phonological systems. The first half of the class will involve a sequence of labs around competing analyses of coronal stop deletion. In the second half of the class, we will do labs about sound change in vowels and about sign language variation.

This course is cross-listed as a 300-level course and a 500-level course. These sections meet together, but requirements and evaluation will be differentiated by level. The contents of this syllabus are subject to change. Updated versions of the syllabus will be announced and posted on Canvas.

Prerequisite for 336: LING 001 or LING 102, or permission of instructor

ASSESSMENT

For students enrolled in LING 336, the course grade will be determined as follows:

- 20% Reading quizzes
- 60% Lab reports
- 20% Final project

For students enrolled in LING 536, the course grade will be based on completion of a final project. Students in 536 will participate in advanced versions of the labs, but lab reports will not be graded.

COURSE POLICIES

Contact:

- Feel free to ask questions by email, but allow 24 hours for a response.
- Announcements from Prof. Tamminga will be sent through Canvas.
- Please put "LING 336" plus a topic in the subject line for all email communications.

Standards for submission:

- Assignments are due **before class** on the date they are listed as being due.
- All coursework should be submitted on Canvas.
- All submitted coursework should be in PDF format, using standard fonts/type size/color, with your last name in the file name and at the top of the page.

Course materials and technology:

- There is no textbook for this course. Readings will be distributed on Canvas.
- All project materials will be posted on Canvas.
- Laptops are permitted in class at all times, but please avoid multitasking out of consideration for your classmates' concentration.
- Laptops are required in class on days where "Lab #:" appears in the day's title.
- You will need access to the software listed later in this syllabus.
- Please treat Prof. Tamminga as a last resort for tech trouble-shooting.

Attendance policy:

- The material for this course is not easy to make up, so attendance is mandatory for students enrolled in 336.
- Students in 336 are allowed one free unexcused absence in the semester. Any additional unexcused absences will negatively impact the course grade: even a couple absences can make a grade difference in an edge case, and many absences can impact the grade by up to two letter grades.
- Absences can be excused by advance arrangement (by email) for religious holidays and Penn-sanctioned travel or events. If those arrangements are not made in advance, the absence will be treated as unexcused.
- Absences for illness may be excused after the fact on an honors system basis.
- It is your responsibility to make up any content you miss for an excused absence. Making up missed content is not an appropriate use of office hours.

Late and missed assessments:

- If you need an extension on a deadline, please contact Prof. Tamminga at least 24 hours in advance.
- Late assignments will be assessed a grade penalty of one letter grade.

Accommodations and nondiscrimination:

- I am happy to arrange any necessary accommodations with appropriate documentation from Student Disability Services.
- If you require disability accommodation, please notify me as soon as possible.
- I am committed to providing a learning environment free of discrimination and harassment. I expect your similar commitment.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Please refer to Penn's academic integrity guide here:

<https://catalog.upenn.edu/pennbook/code-of-academic-integrity/>

For the purposes of this class, you are encouraged to discuss labs with other students to get a handle on the research and analysis aspects of the labs, but **all lab reports must be written up individually**. You may not collaborate on reading quizzes.

Violations of academic integrity will be handled on a case-by-case basis, with possible consequences including zero credit for an assignment, failure in the class, and/or reporting to the Office of Student Conduct for university-level sanctions.

IMPORTANT ADMINISTRATIVE DATES

Aug. 29	First day of class
Oct. 8	Last day to drop
Nov. 9	Last day to withdraw
Dec. 10	Last day of class

REQUIRED SOFTWARE

- **Microsoft Excel:** Available through Penn, instructions at <https://www.isc.upenn.edu/how-to/penn365-students>
- **Praat:** Available for free download at <http://www.fon.hum.uva.nl/praat>
- **ELAN:** Available for free download at <https://tla.mpi.nl/tools/tla-tools/elan>
- **R:** Available for free download at <https://www.r-project.org/>
- **RStudio:** Available for free download at <https://www.rstudio.com/>

SCHEDULE OF TOPICS AND ASSIGNMENTS**Wed Aug. 29 Course introduction**

In class: Go over syllabus. Intro to the quantitative study of language variation.

Reading for class: None

Homework due: None

Mon Sept 3 Labor Day, no class

Wed Sept. 5 Variable rules

In class: Discussion of Labov et al. 1968 2.3-2.4.3

Reading for class: Labov et al. 1968 2.3-2.4.3, Tagliamonte 2006 Ch. 5

Due before class: Reading Quiz 1 (on Labov et al. 1968 2.3-2.4.3)

Mon Sept. 10 Lab 0: Introduction to R

In class: Workshop on R programming

Reading for class: None

Due before class: Nothing

Wed Sept. 12 Basics of phonology

In class: Lecture on phonological frameworks

Reading for class: Kenstowicz 1994 Sect. 5.1-5.7

Due before class: Nothing

Mon Sept. 17 Functionalism in variation

In class: Discussion of Labov 1994

Reading for class: Labov 1994 Ch. 19 (for 536, also read Ch. 20)

Due before class: Reading Quiz 2 (on Labov 1994 Ch. 19)

Wed Sept. 19 Lab 1: Functional analysis of CSD

In class: Lab 1

Reading for class: None

Due before class: Nothing

Mon Sept. 24 The exponential hypothesis

In class: Discussion of Guy 1991a

Reading for class: Guy 1991a (for 536, also read Guy 1991b)

Due before class: Reading Quiz 3 (on Guy 1991a)

Wed Sept. 26 Lab 2: Grammatical analysis of CSD

In class: Lab 2

Reading for class: None

Due before class: Lab 1 report

Mon Oct. 1 Usage-based phonology

In class: Discussion of Bybee 2002

Reading for class: Bybee 2002

Due before class: Reading Quiz 4 (on Bybee 2002)

Wed Oct. 3 Lab 3: Frequency analysis of CSD

In class: Lab 3

Reading for class: None

Due before class: Lab 2 report

Mon Oct. 8 Gradience in phonological variation

In class: Discussion of Temple 2014

Reading for class: Temple 2014, Ladefoged & Johnson 2015 Ch. 8

Due before class: Reading Quiz 5 (on Temple 2014)

Wed Oct. 10 Lab 4: Acoustic analysis of CSD

In class: Lab 4

Reading for class: None

Due before class: Lab 3 report

Mon Oct. 15 Basics of vowels

In class: Lecture on the phonetics of vowels

Reading due: Ladefoged & Johnson 2015 Ch. 9

Due before class: Nothing

Wed Oct. 17 NWAV showcase

In class: NWAV practice talks

Reading due: None

Due before class: Lab 4 report

Mon Oct. 22 Guest lecture: Dr. Danielle Turton

In class: Guest lecture, topic TBA

Reading due: TBA

Due before class: Nothing

Wed Oct. 24 Guest lecture: Dr. Miriam Meyerhoff

In class: Guest lecture, topic TBA

Reading due: TBA

Due before class: Nothing

Mon Oct. 29 Basics of FAVE

In class: Lecture on forced alignment and vowel extraction

Reading due: None

Due before class: Nothing

Wed Oct. 3 Basics of sound change

In class: Lecture on sound change

Reading due: Labov 1994 Sect. 11.2 (for 536, read all of Ch. 11)

Homework due: Nothing

Mon Nov. 5 Phonological conditioning of sound change

In class: Discussion of Fruehwald 2016

Reading due: Fruehwald 2016

Due before class: Reading Quiz 6 (on Fruehwald 2016)

Wed Nov. 7 Lab 5: /ay/-raising in Philadelphia

In class: Lab 5

Reading due: None

Homework due: Nothing

Mon Nov. 12 Guest lecture: Dr. Jami Fisher: Sign language phonology

In class: Guest lecture on the basics of sign language phonology

Reading due: Johnson & Liddell 2011

Homework due: Nothing

Wed Nov. 14 The Philadelphia Signs Project

In class: Intro to the Philly Signs Project

Reading due: None

Homework due: Lab 5 report

Mon Nov. 19 Coding sign language variation

In class: Discussion of Sáfár & Crasborn 2013

Reading due: Sáfár & Crasborn 2013

Homework due: Reading Quiz 7 (on Sáfár & Crasborn 2013)

Wed Nov. 21 Friday schedule, no class

Mon Nov. 26 Lab 6: Weak hand variation in ASL

In class: Lab 6 (no report; submit work from class)

Reading due: None

Homework due: Nothing

Wed Nov. 28 Intro to final project

In class: Final project intro and brainstorming time

Reading due: None

Homework due: Nothing

Mon Dec. 3 Final project work time

In class: Final project work time

Reading due: None

Homework due: Nothing

Wed Dec. 5 536 final presentations

In class: 536 final presentations

Reading due: None

Homework due: Nothing

Mon Dec. 10 336 final presentations

In class: 336 final presentations

Reading due: None

Homework due: Final presentation (336)

(Final project reports due Dec 14)